Eskom- Expo

A journey of patchy internet connectivity, limited devices, navigating online mentorship and participating in a Science Expo for the very 1st time is not an easy journey.

The 4 learners from Phuthini Secondary School went from 45 learners who applied for our mentorship slowly the numbers decreased because and not limited to the reasons mentioned above.

Unfamiliar can cause discomfort and lead people to stopping but they went through with the journey, navigating research for the very 1st time, enabled to be problem solvers they noticed critical challenges within their community and challenged themselves to push through.

We would like to congratulate all of them for making it this far, in the regionals of the competition and a Special congratulations to Sandakahle Mazibuko for earning a bronze medal for her project.

This is indeed a proud moment for us, their potential has been unlocked as they have expressed entering again next year, this means we have done our part, they have a foundational skills to keep them going.

We are grateful to the Phuthini Secondary School for trusting us with their learners, educators who worked extra hours to support them, community members who showed up when the learners were raising funds for their projects.

Well done Fanelesibonge Mazibuko, Mbalenhle Khumalo, Nosimilo Mazibuko, and Sandakahle Mazibuko
💝 🤎 🚀 🚀

#Eskomexpo #highschool #singawefoundation #ruralareas

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Phuthini won silver in 2025 and bronze in 2026

From Training to Launch: The Loskop Expo is officially live! 🚀

I am incredibly proud to announce that on May 16th, 2026, we successfully launched the Loskop Expo at Phuthini Secondary School, Enyezane. This milestone marks a significant step in our mission to foster

innovation and critical thinking among learners in the region.

This journey, however, began long before the launch day. It started in February with the 1st Loskop Expo Training, where we laid the foundation for what was to come. Since then, SINGAWE Innovative has been on the ground, guiding and mentoring these bright young minds every step of the way. Our journey involved identifying the right schools, reaching out to build relationships, and consistently mentoring the learners to prepare them for this moment.

We were thrilled to have three schools participate in this inaugural event:
🏫 Phuthini Secondary School
🏫 Sizathina High School
🏫 Enkomokazini Technical High School

The Science skom Expo is not easy, especialy if you are doing it for the very 1st time, strugling with network connectivity and mostly working with limited device access and online mentorship.

We went from 42 learners who showed interest, we went to 22 learners who stayed the course, and only 11 completed their research papers in time for the competition day. All of them are fighters, and they have learnt a lot during their time with us. But due to minor obstacles we are looking to work on in the future, not all the learners made it to the presentation day.

A huge thank you to the Estcourt Coordinator for making this possible, and to Phuthini Secondary School for their incredible support in hosting us.
The results are in, and we will be sharing them soon.

We are truly grateful to everyone who has been part of this journey, especially the dedicated SINGAWE team for their unwavering commitment to shaping the future of these learners.

And mostly the learners from their time, dedication. This is only the beginning.

Charlene Makwara: Department of Technology, Research and innovation :From Community Practice to Scholarly Knowledge

The Singawe Foundation is honoured to have been accepted to participate in a research project that seeks to document, explore, and transform the knowledge emerging from the community engagement work we do.

Our work is rooted in communities, lived experiences, and the belief that meaningful change begins by listening, learning, and responding to the realities people face. Being part of this research journey provides an exciting opportunity to translate these experiences into scholarly knowledge that can contribute to stronger practice, innovation, and sustainable community impact.

We are especially honoured to be represented by **Charlene Makwara**, who is participating in the Practitioner-to-Scholar (PTS) Programme Capacity Building Workshop at SICAS Guest House, Westridge, as we take this important step forward in the research project for the next 2 days.

The two-day workshop, themed “From Community Practice to Scholarly Knowledge,” is equipping practitioners with valuable tools and insights in areas including sustainable community organisations, resource mobilisation and fundraising, research fundamentals, engaged scholarship, research design, data collection, and ethical research practices.

For us at Singawe Foundation, this is more than a research opportunity. It is an opportunity to ensure that the knowledge generated through our community work is recognised, documented, and shared in ways that can inspire learning and contribute to meaningful social change.

We extend our sincere appreciation to the facilitators and speakers: Phumzile Xulu, Dr Yâchal du Plessis, Dr Thulile Mofokeng, and Dr Vaneshree Govender, for creating a space where practitioners can grow into scholar-leaders.

We are proud of Charlene and grateful for the opportunity to embark on this journey. We look forward to seeing our community-based experiences translated into knowledge that can strengthen practice and contribute to the broader field of community development.

From the community, through practice, into knowledge and ultimately, towards greater impact. 🌍

From being a SINGAWE Mentee to being a SINGAWE Mentor 🤝 🤍that's Olwethu's Eskom Expo story. 🌟

Olwethu's journey with Singawe Foundation started as a mentee at Phuthini Secondary School, when she was first introduced to the Eskom Expo. She went on to compete and win Silver at the Regionals, proof of the hard work and belief that Singawe pours into every young mind it mentors.

This year, the story came full circle. Olwethu, now a student at UKZN studying Accounting, returned to the Eskom Expo Regionals not as a competitor, but as a Singawe mentor.

Here's what she had to say about the experience:

"Being a judge at the Eskom Expo Regionals was a wonderful and meaningful experience. I represented Singawe Foundation and judged projects in Computer Science and Software Development, the same category I competed in last year.

I was impressed by the amazing projects and the creativity of the learners. Oh I also met new friends from DUT and UKZN 🤭, which made the experience even more special. I decided to become a judge because I wanted to give back to the Expo community and support other young innovators. I feel proud and grateful to have experienced the Expo from a different perspective this year. I would encourage anyone considering becoming a judge or participating next year to go for it, it is a great opportunity to learn, meet new people and be inspired by amazing ideas."

This is what it looks like when mentorship comes full circle. Today's mentee is tomorrow's mentor. 💛

Olwethu Mswane

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FOR YOUNG SCIENTISTS

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TACA

Bringing career guidance closer to home. 📍

From the 10th to the 14th of August, Singawe Foundation visited 8 schools in Loskop, alongside the DUT Student Recruitment Department, with our program **#TACA** (Technology Awareness Career Advisory). This is an increase in the number of schools reached compared to our previous visits.

We brought along our **CareerKit** board, giving learners a hands on opportunity to engage with different career paths and start thinking seriously about their futures.

This marks our third consecutive year visiting schools in **#Estcourt**, the second time alongside DUT. We are grateful for the opportunity to keep showing up for these communities year after year, and even more grateful to be reaching more learners each time.

Our journey does not end with the school visits. We are continuing to walk alongside matriculants as they make informed decisions about their careers, and assisting as many learners as possible with their applications before the deadlines.

To every learner we engaged with, thank you for your curiosity and openness. To DUT, thank you for partnering with us once again. 💛

women in ICT bootcamp challenge, held in 2025

Mentees/Journeyers: Dakalo Mutswaletswale, Fanelesbonge Mthiyane,Mandisa Biyela,Nosiseko Duku, Sinothando Mthalane


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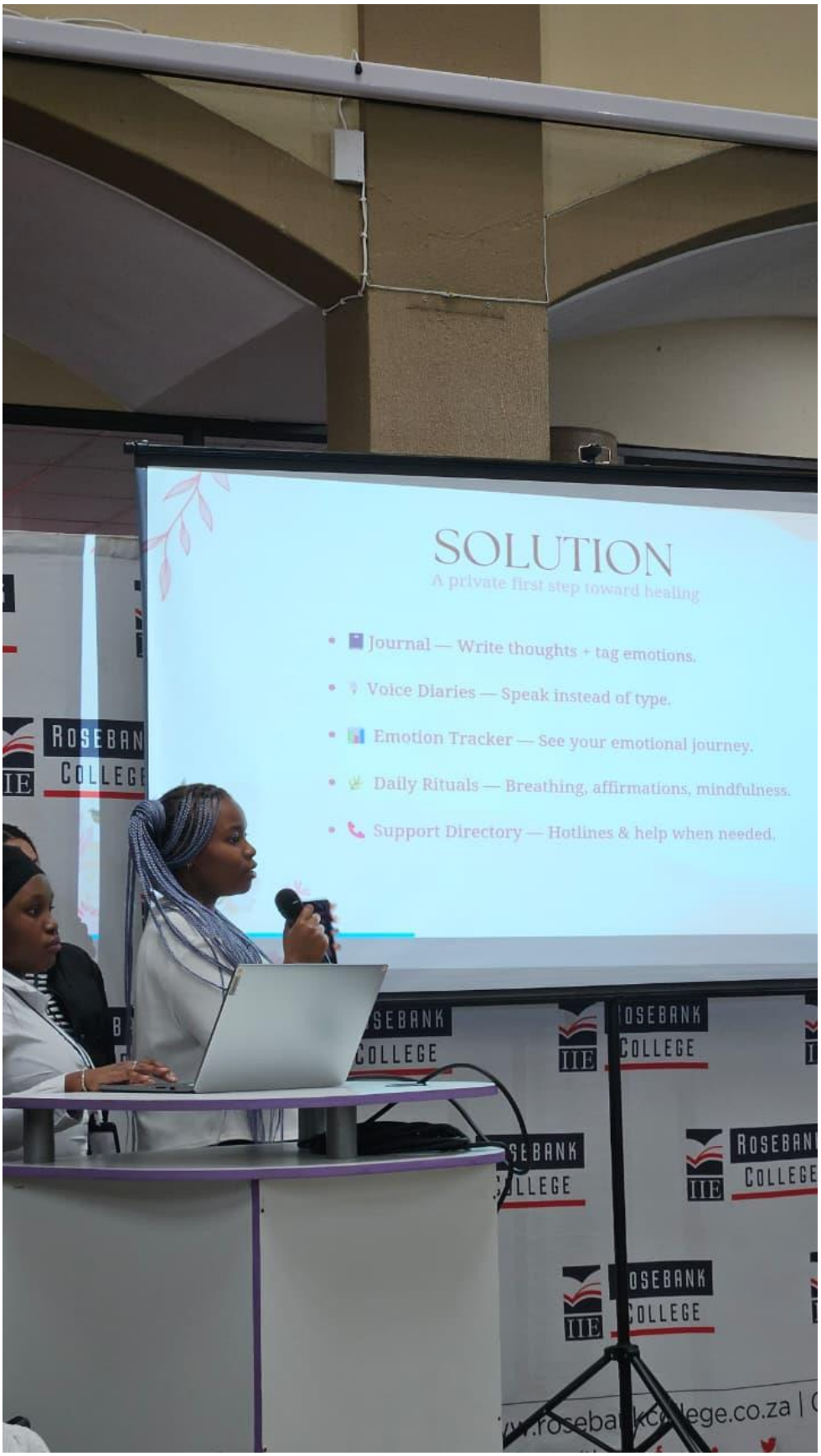

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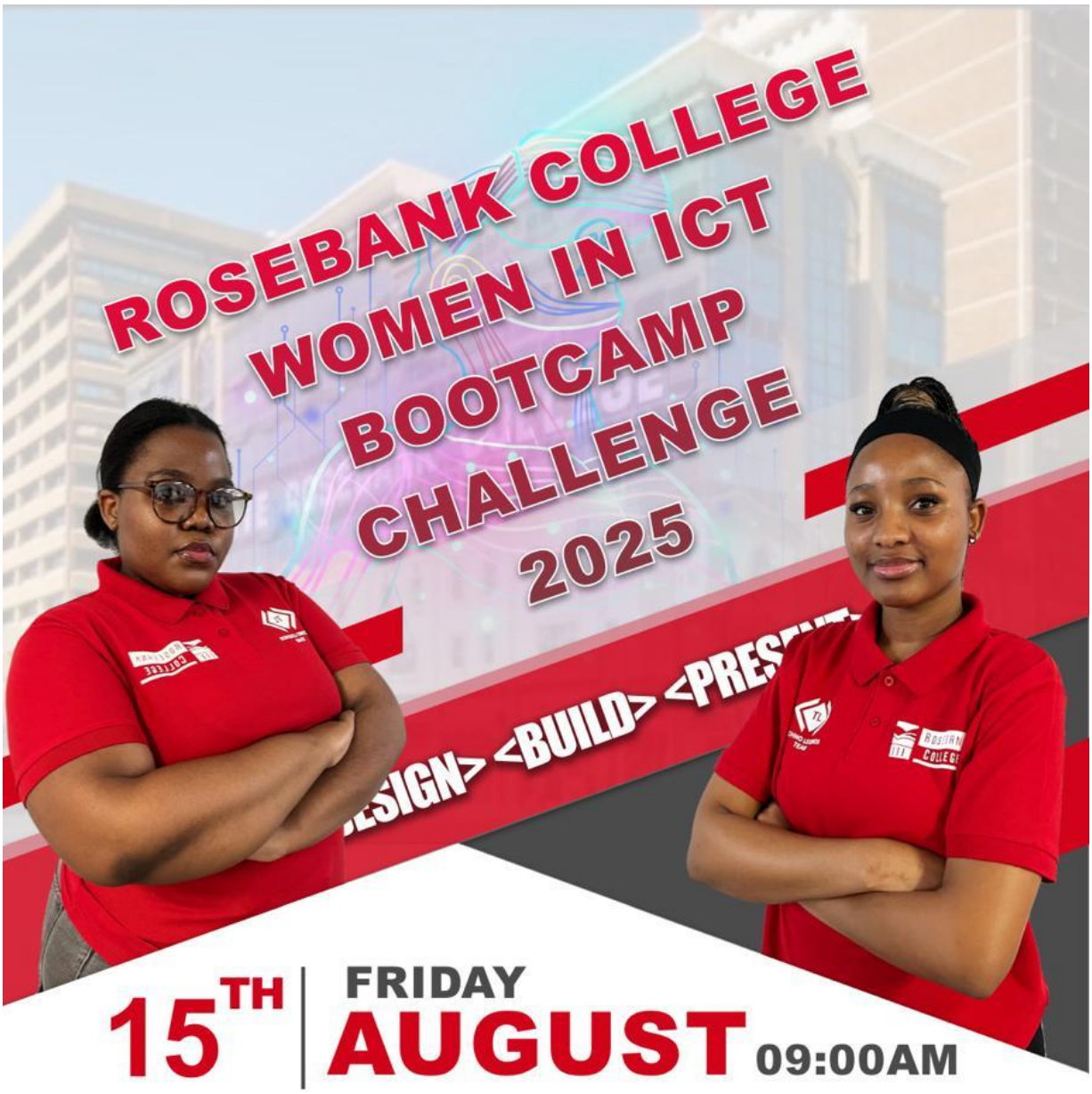

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WOMEN IN ICT BOOTCAMP
CHALLENGE 2025
PROGRAM
MANDISA BIYELA
PARTICIPANT


SOLUTION
A private first step toward healing
Journal — Write thoughts + tag emotions.
Voice Diaries — Speak instead of type.
Emotion Tracker — See your emotional journey.
Daily Rituals — Breathing, affirmations, mindfulness.
Support Directory — Hotlines & help when needed.
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15TH | FRIDAY AUGUST 09:00AM

Join us on 15 Aug 2025 at the **Atrium** for the Women in ICT Bootcamp Challenge Presentations & Awards Day, where we will showcase innovative projects created after an intensive two-week bootcamp and challenge week. The event will feature students from DUT, MUT, Richfield, Eduvos, and Varsity College, guest speakers from NYDA on Women Financial Empowerment, and a special music performance dedicated to Women's Month. The dress code is formal with a Black & White theme. Come and celebrate creativity, innovation, and the power of women in ICT.

Partnered with:

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Atrium

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